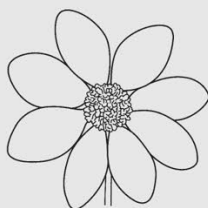


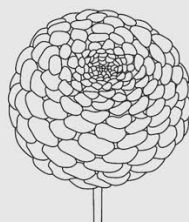
# DAHLIAS

The wide spectrum of dahlia hybrids offers a bold display of color and form from summer to the first frosts in fall. Dahlias flower prolifically—in the right conditions a single plant may produce up to 100 blooms during a single season. Flowers range in size from tiny 2in (5cm) pompons to huge exhibition blooms more than 10in (25cm) across. They make beautiful border plants, the compact types are ideal for containers, and all are good for cutting. In addition, no special skills are required to grow them, except protecting the tubers from frost. Dahlias are divided into groups according to the form of their flower heads. The most commonly grown are illustrated below. Some dahlias have fimbriated (split or notched) petals, and some (such as orchid-flowering dahlias) are available in single and double forms.

**Single-flowered**—flowers usually have 8–10 broad petals surrounding an open, central disc.



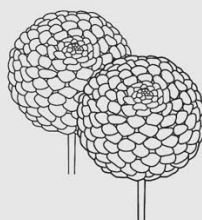
**Ball**—spherical, fully double flowers, sometimes slightly flattened on top, with densely packed, almost tubular, petals.



**Anemone-flowered**—fully double flowers, each with one or more rings of flattened ray petals surrounding a dense group of shorter, tubular petals, usually longer than the petals of single dahlias.



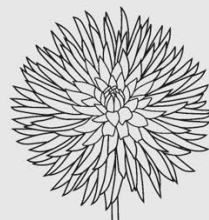
**Pompon**—a miniature form of ball flowers, but more spherical in shape, with fully double flowers no more than 2in (5cm) in diameter.



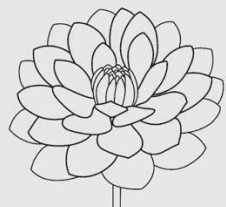
**Collerette**—single flowers with 8–10 broad, outer petals, and an inner 'collar' of smaller petals surrounding an open, central disc.



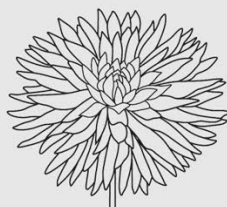
**Cactus**—fully double flowers with narrow, pointed petals that can be straight or curl inward and have recurved edges for more than two-thirds of their length.



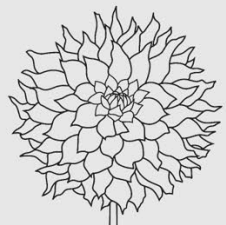
**Waterlily**—fully double flowers with large, generally sparse ray petals, which are flat or with slightly incurved or recurved margins, giving the flower a flat appearance.



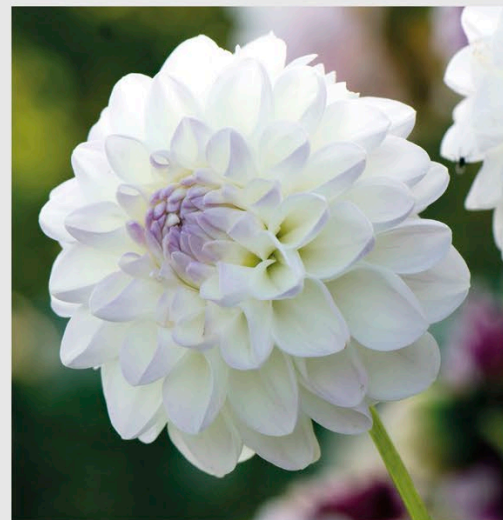
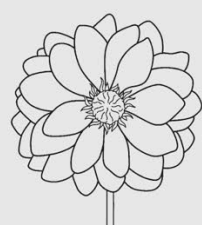
**Semi-cactus**—fully double flowers similar to cactus types, but with broader-based petals, the edges of which are generally recurved toward their tips.



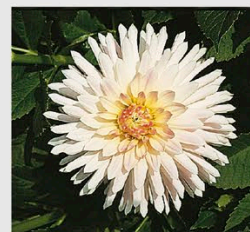
**Decorative**—fully double flowers with no visible central disc, and broad, flat petals, sometimes twisted, that incurve slightly at their margins.



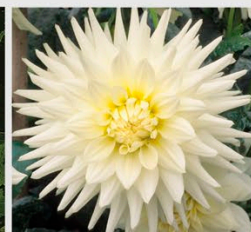
**Peony-flowered**—large, semidouble flowers, with several rows of irregularly arranged, flattened petals, surrounding an open, central disc.



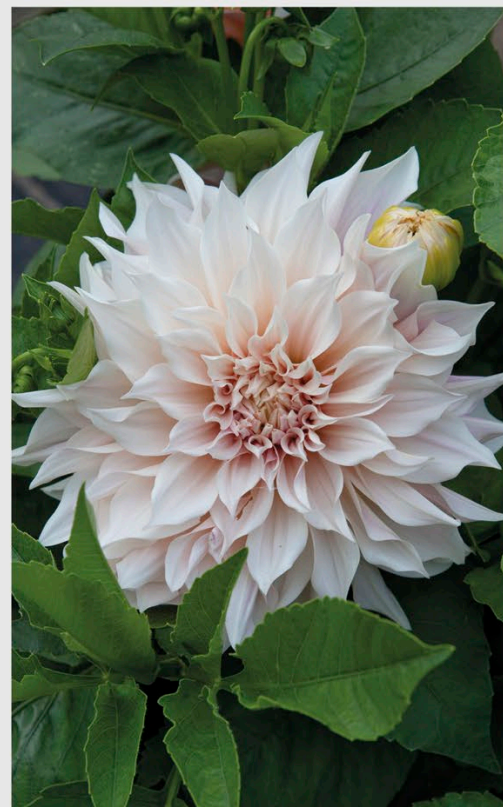
*D. 'Eveline'*  
[decorative]



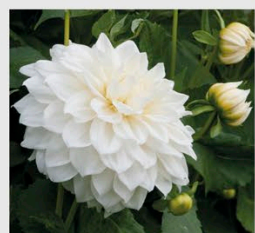
*D. 'Trelyn Kiwi'*  
[semi-cactus]



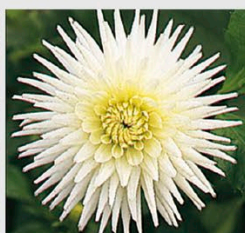
*D. 'White Moonlight'*  
[semi-cactus]



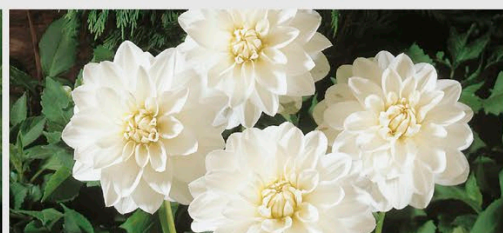
*D. 'Café au Lait'*  
[decorative]



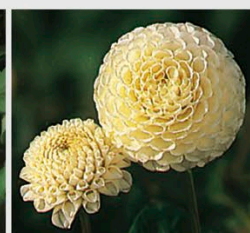
*D. 'White Alva's'* [decorative]



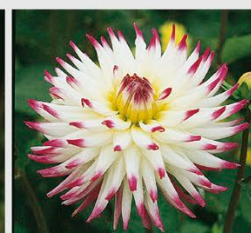
*D. 'White Klankstad'* [cactus]



*D. 'White Ballet'* [waterlily]



*D. 'Small World'* [pompon]



*D. 'Jura'* [semi-cactus]